

* What is the Problem statement ?

The surge in spend because everyone used AI across their workflows (Product, Operations, content, & Int. support)

* What I would do & in what order ?

Goals:

Day 1 : Assess before touching anything

- Get read access to cloud billing, Open AI dashboard, Google AI studio, & workflows run logs. → changes
- Ask finance for the last 3 invoices & what triggered the alert → exact numbers
- Send an announcement message to all Product leads "List all AI workflow change you made in the last 30 days - (no meeting needed)"
- Ask IT for a list of active API keys & their assigned teams without any revocations yet
- Build a rough cost map

workflow name	Owner	Last changed	Status
Doesn't need to be 100% completed.			

Goal:

Day 2: Find what actually workflows drove the surge

- Cross reference Finance invoices line items against team API Keys' owners list

- Flag Top 3-5 cost contributors → owner's name

- Identify any workflows with no owners

↳ Highest risk & need a decision not an audit

Goal

Day 3: Now is the time for action but without Panie

- COO update with the findings

- Contact owners of the top cost items → Privately

↳ Asking them about their workflows

~~Start~~ Start a shared registering document, owned

by my AI ops team → update weekly ~~so~~ so it won't happen again

- Identify one workflow that is misconfigured or over calling & Propose a fix to the owner

* Preventing this from happening again

- Registry stays live → Not a one time audit
- Updated weekly → Low friction, High value
- API Keys are named from day one → Every new Key Puts a name tag & makes future bills attributable
- 15 min. monthly review with Finance → did anything jump?
- All workflow changes go in a shared log
- Once we have a 4-6 weeks of data in the registry we write a lightweight policy

* Assumptions

- Read access is available without a formal approval Process → Lengthy Approval chain = Ops Problem as we can't see immediately what we are responsible for
- Product leads will respond to slack request quickly → if not, that's a deeper ownership issue not just tools.
- Retention of logs from IT from the surge period → if not that's a gap to fix
- Cost & visibility rather than a security incident → In the research if it's a security incident, that becomes a different Process